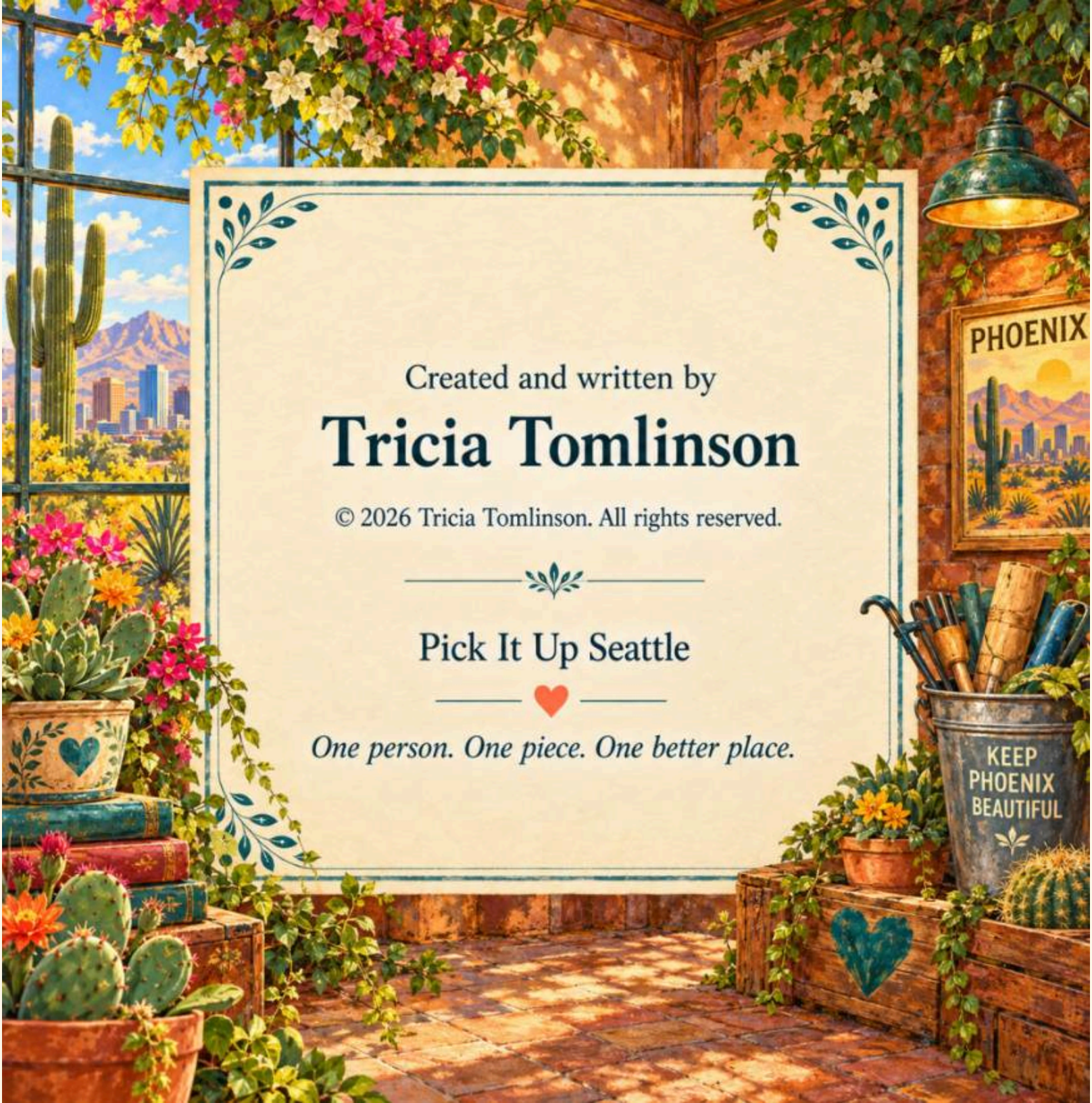
Mess Master and the Traveling Trash!

A Pick It Up Seattle Story

By Tricia Tomlinson



One person.
One piece.
One better place.



Created and written by

Tricia Tomlinson

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Pick It Up Seattle

One person. One piece. One better place.


Imagine... if every person left every place better than they found it.
That's the idea behind Pick It Up Together.
Pick It Up Together is a community movement built around one simple belief: small actions matter. Picking up one piece of litter, sharing a cleanup, recognizing someone who helped, discovering something beautiful in our community, or inspiring someone else to join in — every small act helps make our world a little better.
Our website is a place to celebrate those actions and the people behind them. You can share cleanups and before-and-after photos, discover community events, leave thank-you notes, explore Scenic Discoveries, read stories, and find simple ways to take part.
Because creating a cleaner, brighter place doesn't have to begin with something big.
It can begin with one person, one piece, and one better place.
PickItUpTogether.org
PHOENIX



WHOOSH!

A wrapper smacked the classroom window.
"Someone's knocking," said Belle.
"With no hands?" asked Oliver.



"Mess Master! What are you doing in Arizona?"
asked Oliver.
"I needed a break from rainy Seattle!"
said Mess Master.



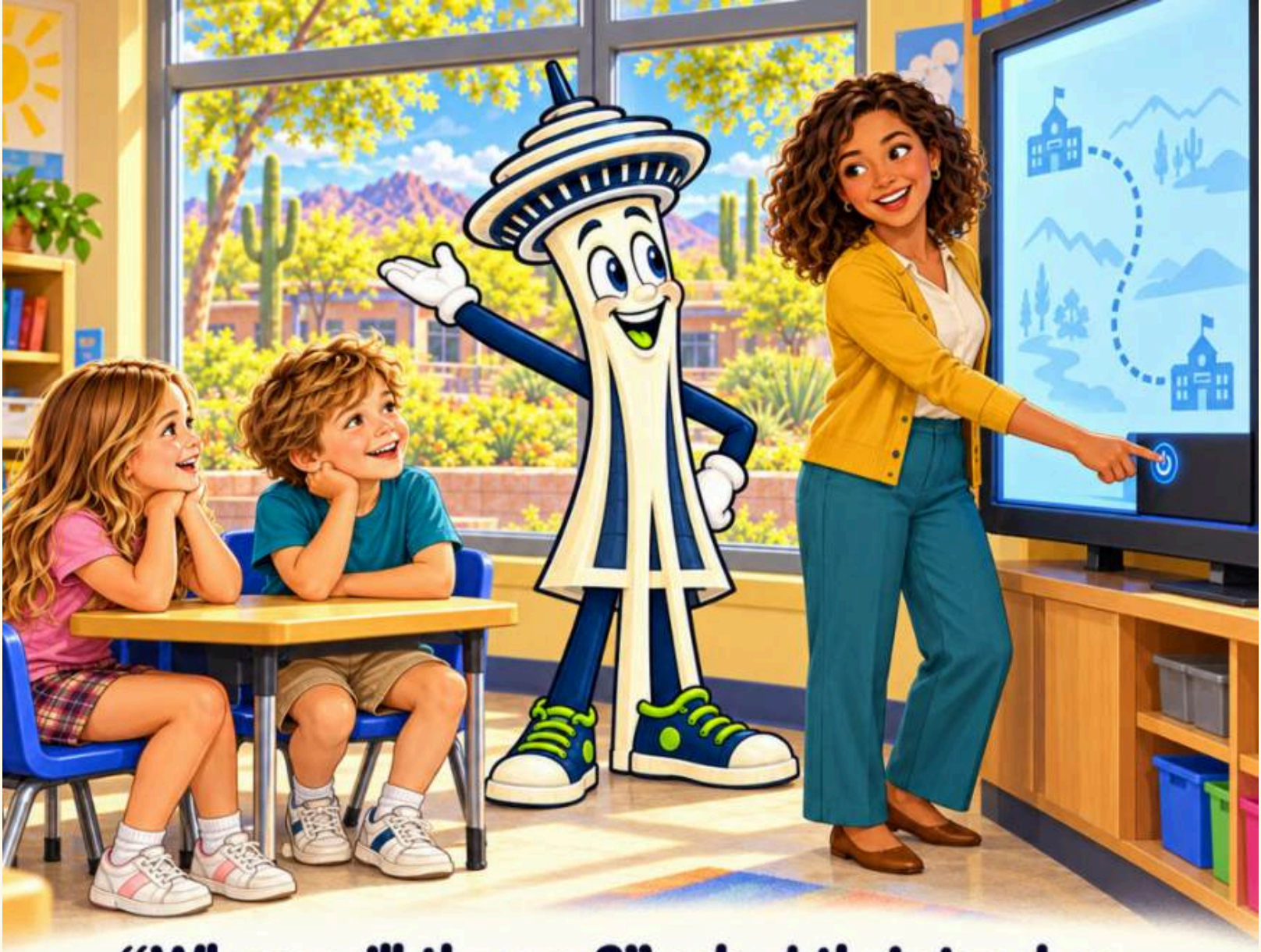
Mess Master pressed his nose to the glass.
Outside lay a wrapper, a paper cup,
and a crumpled bag.
“Your friends are here,” said **Beau.**



The bag puffed up.
The cup rolled.
The wrapper cartwheeled.
“Your friends need manners,” said **Olivia.**



Olivia pointed at the litter.
“Those aren’t my friends!”
“Good,” said Mess Master.
“They didn’t wipe their feet.”



“Where will they go?” asked their teacher.
“Hopefully another school,” said Mess Master.
“Let’s find out.”
She switched on the classroom screen.



On the screen, rain swept litter
along a Phoenix curb.
"Where's it going?" asked Beau.
"When rain comes, water can move fast,"
said their teacher.



The cup bobbed toward a storm drain.
"A tiny boat!" said Belle.
"With a terrible captain," said Oliver.
"Drains can lead to waterways," said their teacher.



Next stop: rainy Seattle!
"That's my city!" said Mess Master.
Leaves and litter gathered over a drain.
"A trash traffic jam!"
said Mess Master.
"Litter can block water's path,"
said their teacher.



In San Francisco, a bag blew toward the bay.
Olivia leaned forward.
“Fish don’t need shopping bags!”
“Let’s keep them out of the water,”
said Belle.



Oliver raised his hand.

"What if we catch litter BEFORE it travels?"

Mess Master stood up.

"Excellent! I shall Command the wind!"



Outside, with their teacher,
Mess Master struck a mighty pose.
"WIND! STOP!"
The wind blew his cape over his head.
"Very commanding," said Oliver.



Their teacher checked a safe cleanup spot.
Everyone put on gloves.
Beau carried the bags.

"I BROUGHT TWO!"

"One for each hand?" asked Mess Master.



"Garbage and recycling," said **Beau**.
"First, we check our local guide," said their teacher.
Oliver nodded.

"Bins have rules. Apparently wind doesn't."



SNIP!

Their teacher's grabber caught the wrapper.

PLOP!

Into the garbage bag it went.

"Your cartwheel career is over,"

said Belle.



An empty plastic bottle lay beside the bench.
Their teacher checked the guide.
"This bottle is accepted here."
Beau held open the recycling bag.
"Special delivery!"



Olivia raised her reusable water bottle.

"Mine gets refilled, not thrown away!"

Mess Master nodded.

"Smart bottle. Steady job."



Something shiny lay ahead.
"Broken glass," said Oliver.
Everyone stepped back.
"Leave it. Tell a grown-up,"
said their teacher.
"Gloves aren't magic," added Beau.



Across the road sat a giant dumped chair.
"Too big. Unsafe spot," said Belle.
Their teacher checked how to report it.
Mess Master sighed.
"I wasn't going to fit that in Beau's bag."



Back inside, everyone washed their hands.
Mess Master admired the bubbles.

"My cleanest victory!"

"Your cape still has a leaf,"
said Olivia.



Their teacher showed a photo of the school walkway.

Wrapper. Cup. Bottle. Bag.

"Was that really our path?" asked **Belle.**

"Count the litter," said **Oliver.**



The next photo showed the very same view.
A clear walkway. A tidy bench.
“Same place?” asked Mess Master.
“Same place. Looks better!” said Beau.



Another photo showed the garden beside the school gate.

Paper scraps hid beneath the flowers.

"Terrible hide-and-seek players," said **Olivia.**

"I can see all of them!"



The garden sparkled in the matching after photo.
Mess Master grinned.
“Does the wind get points?”
“Only if it uses a bin,” said Oliver.



“STREET CHALLENGE!”
announced Mess Master.
“What’s that?” asked Olivia.
“You’ll see in our next adventure!”


They knew how to stop litter from traveling.
One person.
One piece.
One better place.
And they all lived happily ever after.

What did we learn?

Recycling



Garbage



Reuse



Ready, set, clean up!

Our tools



Stay safe!



With a grown-up



Leave sharp things



Stay off the road



Wash your hands



PICK IT UP SEATTLE

ONE PERSON. ONE PIECE. ONE BETTER CITY.

Small actions can make a big difference.

Thank you for being part of the solution!

Learn more, share your cleanups, and get involved at:

PickItUpTogether.org

One person. One piece. One better place.

Join Mess Master, Olivia, Belle, Oliver, and Beau as they discover that small choices can make a **BIG** difference!



IN THIS STORY YOU WILL:

- ☑ See the problem
- ☑ Learn the power of one
- ☑ Learn how to contribute
- ☑ Learn how to recycle
- ☑ Learn how to reuse
- ☑ Inspire others

See litter? Pick it up.
Spot a can. Toss it in.
Because every cleaner place starts the same way:
One person. One piece. One better place.

THANK YOU, LITTER HERO!

PICK IT UP TOGETHER

PickItUpTogether.org